CSE0001 — DIGITAL LITERACY

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Digital Literacy in the Modern Age

A visual guide for first-year B.Tech students — stay informed, stay safe, stay professional

5B+	80%	1930
Internet users worldwide	Jobs need digital skills	Cyber crime helpline (India)

WHAT IS DIGITAL LITERACY?

Definition

The ability to find, evaluate, create and communicate information using digital technology — confidently and responsibly.

Why it matters for you

Employers, internship coordinators, and professors expect you to collaborate online, communicate professionally, and stay cyber-safe.

USEFUL DIGITAL TOOLS FOR STUDENTS

Code & Learn

GitHub · HackerRank · CodeChef

Collaborate

Google Drive · Google Meet · Notion

Create & Present

Canva · Prezi · Piktochart

SAFE INTERNET PRACTICES

1. Use a **strong, unique password** for every account — never reuse the same one.
2. Enable **two-factor authentication (2FA)** on email, GitHub, and bank apps.
3. **Never click suspicious links** in SMS, WhatsApp, or email — verify the sender first.
4. Use only **official UPI apps** (BHIM, GPay, PhonePe) and never share OTPs with anyone.
5. Report cybercrime at cybercrime.gov.in or call helpline 1930 (available 24×7).

PROFESSIONAL ONLINE PRESENCE — PLATFORMS TO BUILD YOUR PROFILE

LinkedIn

Professional networking — add education, skills & connect with recruiters

Professional

GitHub

Host your projects, README portfolio & collaborate on open source

Code

HackerRank

Earn skill badges & certificates that appear on LinkedIn

Code

CodeChef

Competitive programming contests — build a star rating & problem-solving record

Code

TryHackMe

Gamified cybersecurity learning — earn badges & a public profile rank to show employers your hands-on security skills

Cyber Security

CyberDefenders

Blue-team focused CTF challenges — practise real-world incident response & digital forensics with a verifiable score

Cyber Security

EMAIL ETIQUETTE — COMMUNICATE PROFESSIONALLY

Anatomy of a professional email

① Subject Line	② Greeting	③ Body	④ Call to Action	⑤ Sign-off
Clear & specific — state the purpose	Dear Prof. / Dear Sir or Madam	Short, clear paragraphs — one idea each	State what you need clearly	Regards / Sincerely + full name & reg no.

✅ Do's

- ✓ Use your college email address for all academic communication
- ✓ Write a clear, specific subject line (e.g. "Deadline Extension Request — CSE0001")
- ✓ Address professors as "Dear Prof. [Last Name]"
- ✓ Keep emails brief and to the point
- ✓ Proofread for spelling and grammar before sending

❌ Don'ts

- ✗ Never use slang, emojis, or informal language in professional emails
- ✗ Don't leave the subject line blank — emails without subjects are often ignored
- ✗ Avoid "Hey" or "Hi" as greetings in formal contexts
- ✗ Don't send emails in anger — draft, wait, then review
- ✗ Never share sensitive info (OTPs, passwords) over email